

Lyuba, the baby mammoth

In 2007, a Siberian caribou-herder came across a remarkably well preserved, frozen baby mammoth. Lyuba (Lee-OO-bah), as the mammoth came to be known (after the herder's wife), is thought to have died around 40,000 years ago. She is the best specimen of a mammoth ever found.



▲ LYUBA was found in Russia's Arctic Yamal Peninsula, shown by a dot on the map.



DID YOU KNOW?

- Lyuba is small. She is just 4 ft long by 3 ft wide (1.2 m x 90 cm).
- Scientists believe Lyuba was about 30 days old when she died.
- The mammoth may have died from suffocation after being trapped in mud.
- Lyuba had "milk tusks"—small tusks that fall out before the adult tusks grow.



Scientists discovered a store of fat cells at the back of Lyuba's neck, which would have been used to provide energy for keeping the baby mammoth warm in its cold surroundings.

► **HIDDEN CLUES** *By studying the place in which Lyuba was found, the team concluded that her body had been exposed for a year before its discovery.*

Lyuba was so well preserved that scientists even found milk that she'd suckled from her mother in her stomach.

